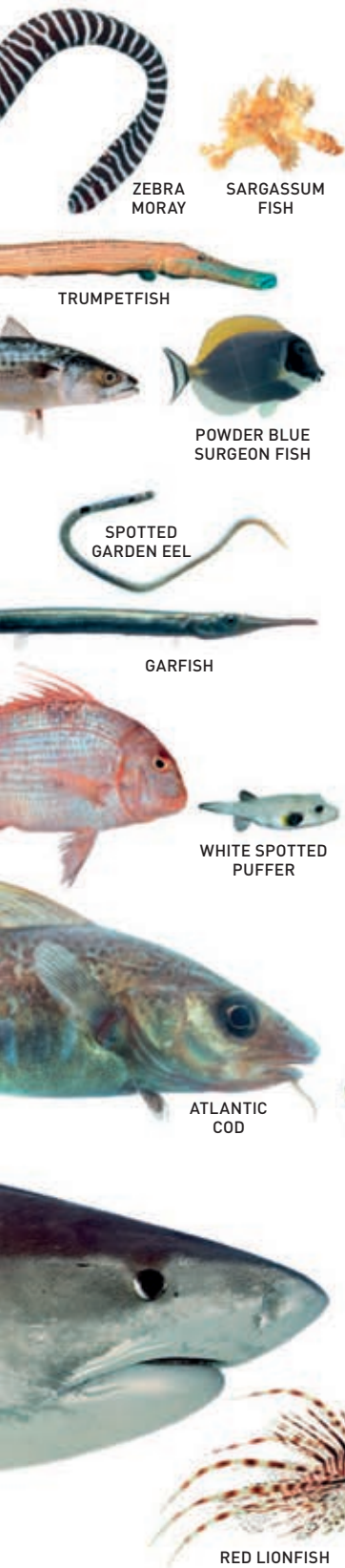




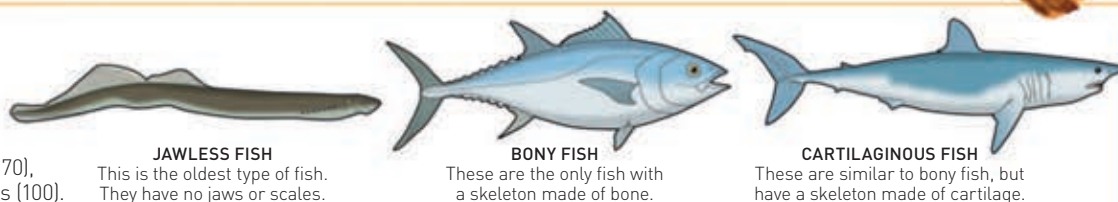
FRESHWATER FISH

Around 14,000 fish species live in fresh (non-salty) water in lakes, streams, rivers, and ponds. Some fish, known as euryhaline fish, can adapt to live in salty or fresh water.



TYPES OF FISH

There are three main types of fish: jawless, bony, and cartilaginous. Bony species make up the highest number (27,000), then cartilaginous (970), and finally the jawless species (100).



JAWLESS FISH

This is the oldest type of fish. They have no jaws or scales.

BONY FISH

These are the only fish with a skeleton made of bone.

CARTILAGINOUS FISH

These are similar to bony fish, but have a skeleton made of cartilage.

DEFENCE

Most fish do not have weapons (such as spines) on their bodies to defend themselves, so they do clever things to make themselves look bigger or disappear from view.



SWIMMING IN GROUPS

A group of fish swimming in a school looks to a predator like one big fish.



BURIED IN SAND

Flat fish can alter the colour and pattern of their skin so they can hide by lying flat in the sand.



HIDING IN ANEMONE

Clownfish hide in the stinging tentacles of sea anemones to avoid predators.



BALLOONING UP

When threatened porcupinefish inflate their bodies to make sharp spines stand up.

CARING FATHERS

Fish don't usually take care of their young. However, for a few species, including the seahorse, the male carries the fertilized eggs in a pouch until they hatch.

Eggs kept safely in pouch



MALE SEAHORSE